

KEY TOPIC 3 • REVISION & PRACTICE COMPANION

Medicine in 18th & 19th Century Britain

c1700–c1900: Ideas on Causes, Prevention, Hospital Care, Surgery & Public Health



Primary Visual Evidence: James Gillray, *The Cow-Pock—or—the Wonderful Effects of the New Inoculation!* (1802 satirical cartoon satirising public fears of Edward Jenner's cowpox vaccine)

HISTORICAL SATIRE ARCHIVE

PUPIL NAME: _____ TARGET: _____ CLASS: _____

KEY TOPIC 3 SPECIFICATION FRAMEWORK (1H10/11)	LESSON DONE	QUIZ [10]
Key Topic 3.1: Ideas on Causes: Pasteur's Germ Theory & Koch's Bacteriology <i>How did swan-neck flasks (1861) and agar cultures (1876–83) demolish spontaneous generation?</i>	☐	☐
Key Topic 3.2: Approaches to Prevention: Edward Jenner & The Smallpox Vaccine <i>How did the 1796 cowpox experiment defeat variolation, and why did opposition persist until 1852?</i>	☐	☐
Key Topic 3.3: Improvements in Hospital Care: Florence Nightingale & Professional Nursing <i>How did Scutari (1854–56), Notes on Nursing (1859), and the pavilion plan transform Victorian mortality?</i>	☐	☐
Key Topic 3.4: The Surgical Revolution: Simpson's Chloroform & Lister's Antiseptics <i>How did Simpson conquer pain, Lister conquer infection, and the 1890s introduce aseptic surgery?</i>	☐	☐
Key Topic 3.5: Public Health & Cholera: John Snow & The 1875 Public Health Act <i>How did John Snow's Broad Street pump map (1854) and the 1875 Act permanently dismantle government laissez-faire?</i>	☐	☐

LIVING TIMELINE • PART 1: VACCINES, ANAESTHETICS & EARLY SANITATION (1700–1854)

Instructions: Complete the timeline sketches and notes as you master each enquiry lesson.

1796 • Edward Jenner: Smallpox Vaccination & Immunology

Key Topic 3.2

Jenner inoculates James Phipps with cowpox pus from Sarah Nelmes, proving cowpox confers immunity against smallpox. Publishes findings in 1798. Despite initial Royal Society scepticism, vaccination eradicates inoculator infection risks and founds immunology.

1847 • James Young Simpson: Chloroform & Anesthesia

Key Topic 3.4

Simpson discovers the potent anaesthetic properties of chloroform in Edinburgh, ending agony during surgery. Queen Victoria's use of chloroform during childbirth (1853) popularises it, enabling complex operations despite the initial 'Black Period' of surgery.

1848 • First Public Health Act & The General Board of Health

Key Topic 3.5

Spurred by Chadwick's 1842 report and epidemic cholera, Parliament passes the permissive 1848 Act. Towns can create local boards of health to supply clean water and drainage, though lack of compulsion leaves most cities vulnerable to filth and contagion.

1854 • John Snow: Broad Street Pump & Waterborne Cholera

Key Topic 3.5

During the Soho epidemic, Snow compiles his famous spot map linking 500+ fatal cholera cases to the Broad Street pump. Removing the handle immediately halts the outbreak, mathematically disproving the miasma theory seven years before Pasteur's Germ Theory.

LIVING TIMELINE • PART 2: GERM THEORY, ANTISEPTICS & COMPULSORY PUBLIC HEALTH (1854–1900)

Instructions: Complete the timeline sketches and notes as you master each enquiry lesson.

1854–56 • Florence Nightingale: Hospital Sanitation at Scutari

Key Topic 3.3

During the Crimean War, Nightingale enforces rigorous cleanliness, ventilation, and fresh nutrition at Scutari hospital, slashing soldier death rates from 40% to 2%. Returns to Britain to establish the Nightingale Training School and author *Notes on Nursing* (1859).

1861 • Louis Pasteur: Germ Theory & Swan-Neck Flask Experiments

Key Topic 3.1

Commissioned by Lille brewers, Pasteur disproves spontaneous generation using swan-neck flasks, demonstrating that airborne microbes cause fermentation and decay. In 1861, he publishes *Germ Theory*, proving microscopic germs cause specific diseases in living organisms.

1865–67 • Joseph Lister: Carbolic Acid Spray & Antiseptic Surgery

Key Topic 3.4

Applying Pasteur's *Germ Theory* to wound sepsis, Lister uses carbolic acid sprays, dressings, and hand-washing during surgery at Glasgow Infirmary. His antiseptic techniques reduce amputee mortality from 46% to 15%, paving the way for modern aseptic operating theatres.

1875 • The Second Public Health Act: End of Laissez-Faire

Key Topic 3.5

Disraeli's government ends laissez-faire by making public health compulsory. Municipal councils are legally required to provide clean piped water, subterranean sewer drainage, street lighting, and medical officers of health, transforming urban life expectancy.

Why did it take 30 years for Germ Theory to transform medical understanding in Britain?

CHRONOLOGICAL INQUIRY SPINE • CORE CAUSAL NARRATIVE

Take precise, structured notes alongside each milestone as your teacher narrates the history

1 c1700–1850s

Spontaneous Generation & Miasma

- Miasma: airborne decay blamed for disease
- Spontaneous generation: rotting creates microbes
- Animalcules observed without disease link
- Anti-contagionist medical orthodoxy

FOCUS CLUE

Why did doctors believe disease created germs, rather than vice versa?

2 1861

Louis Pasteur & Germ Theory

- Investigates beer & wine souring in Lille
- Swan-neck flask traps airborne dust
- Microbes cause decay and fermentation
- 1861: Publishes Germ Theory of decay

FOCUS CLUE

How did the swan-neck flask disprove spontaneous generation?

3 1867–1876

British Scepticism & John Tyndall

- Dr Charlton Bastian defends miasma theory
- Pasteur dismissed in Britain as "mere chemist"
- 1876: Tyndall lectures on dust and germs
- Joseph Lister applies theory to carbolic spray

FOCUS CLUE

Why did British doctors refuse to believe germs caused human illness?

4 1876–1882

Robert Koch & Specific Bacteria

- 1876: Isolates specific anthrax bacillus
- Agar jelly grows pure bacterial cultures
- Methyl violet industrial dye stains bacteria
- 1882: Discovers Mycobacterium tuberculosis

FOCUS CLUE

How did Koch's staining and culture methods prove specificity?

5 1883–1890

Postulates & Microphotography

- 1883: Identifies cholera microbe in Egypt/India
- High-resolution photomicrography proves facts
- 4 Postulates: scientific gold standard
- Permanent scientific defeat of miasma theory

FOCUS CLUE

Why was photomicrography crucial in winning British doctors over?

EXTENDED WRITING ASSESSMENT

Stimulus: Louis Pasteur's Germ Theory (1861) Robert Koch's work on bacteria (You must also use information of your own)

(Response continues on facing page)

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☒ Done

5/24

[illegible]

[4 MARKS • 5 MINS]

Hint: Contrast Pasteur and Koch's laboratory discovery that specific microbes cause disease with the persistent Renaissance belief in miasma and spontaneous generation.

KT3.1: Ideas on Causes: Pasteur's Germ Theory & Koch's Bacteriology

[illegible]

Why did Edward Jenner face fierce resistance despite discovering the smallpox vaccine?

CHRONOLOGICAL INQUIRY SPINE • CORE CAUSAL NARRATIVE

Take precise, structured notes alongside each milestone as your teacher narrates the history

1 1721–1795

Smallpox & Inoculation

- Smallpox killed 40,000+ Britons each year
- Lady Montagu introduced Turkish variolation
- Inoculation risked triggering deadly epidemics
- Suttonian commercial method charged high fees

FOCUS CLUE

Why was inoculation dangerous for poor urban communities?

2 1796–1798

Edward Jenner & The Cowpox Vaccine

- Gloucestershire dairy milkmaids immune to smallpox
- May 1796: Inoculates James Phipps with cowpox
- July 1796: Variolates Phipps—no smallpox develops
- 1798: Publishes empirical findings at own expense

FOCUS CLUE

How did Jenner use scientific experimentation to test folklore?

3 1798–1810s

Medical & Religious Opposition

- Royal Society refuses to publish Jenner's paper
- Dr Woodville uses contaminated hospital needles
- Clergy condemn injecting beast matter into humans
- Anti-vaccine cartoons depict cow heads sprouting

FOCUS CLUE

Why did London doctors and church leaders resist vaccination?

4 1802–1840

Parliamentary Funding & Adoption

- 1802 & 1807: Parliament grants Jenner £30,000
- Napoleon vaccinates entire French grand army
- 1808: Royal Jennerian Society founded
- 1840: Vaccination Act bans dangerous inoculation

FOCUS CLUE

Why did the British government abandon laissez-faire for vaccination?

5 1852–1871

Compulsory Acts & Anti-Vaccine League

- 1852: Vaccination made compulsory for all infants
- 1871: Vaccination officers enforce mandatory fines
- Anti-Vaccination League marches for civil liberty
- Jenner's limit: unable to explain viral mechanism

FOCUS CLUE

Why did making vaccination compulsory spark fierce public protests?

Question 5/6: Evaluative Essay [16+4 marks • 20 mins]

***Edward Jenner's development of the smallpox vaccine was the most significant breakthrough in the prevention of disease in the period c1700–c1900.* How far do you agree? [16+4 marks]**

Stimulus: **Inoculation** **The Public Health Act (1875)** *(You must also use information of your own)*

Write your response in the space provided below:

(Response continues on facing page)

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TIMELINE MISSION

Turn to Pages 2–3 (Key Topic 3.2). In the drawing box, sketch Jenner inoculating James Phipps with cowpox. Annotate how this empirical experiment laid the foundation for modern immunology!

☒ Done

[illegible]

[4 MARKS • 5 MINS]

Hint: Contrast Edward Jenner's safe cowpox vaccination (1796) with earlier seventeenth-century reliance on prayer, quarantine, and risky smallpox inoculation (variolation).

KT3.2: Approaches to Prevention: Edward Jenner & The Smallpox Vaccine

[illegible]

How did Florence Nightingale transform hospitals from death traps into places of cure?

CHRONOLOGICAL INQUIRY SPINE • CORE CAUSAL NARRATIVE

Take precise, structured notes alongside each milestone as your teacher narrates the history

1 c1700–1850

Voluntary Hospitals & Pre-Modern Nursing

- Voluntary hospitals funded by private charity
- Shifted from religious rest to medical treatment
- Nurses untrained, illiterate, paid less than servants
- Dickensian "Sairey Gamp" stereotype: drunk and dirty

FOCUS CLUE

Why were early Victorian hospital wards notorious death traps?

2 1854–1856

Scutari & The Crimean War

- Sidney Herbert sends Nightingale and 38 nurses
- Scutari built over open sewers; filth, typhus, cholera
- Scrubbed wards, clean linen, nutritious food, drains
- Mortality rate plunged from 42% to under 2%

FOCUS CLUE

How did Nightingale's sanitary reforms drastically cut the death rate?

3 1859

Notes on Nursing & Sanitary Science

- 1859: Publishes bestselling *Notes on Nursing*
- Insists on light, fresh air, warmth, cleanliness, diet
- Believed in miasma; hygiene worked despite wrong theory
- Used polar area pie charts to convince MPs

FOCUS CLUE

Why did Nightingale's belief in miasma still produce effective hygiene?

4 1860s

The Pavilion Plan Hospital Design

- Rebuilt hospitals (e.g. St Thomas' Hospital, London)
- Separate ward blocks to isolate infectious diseases
- High ceilings, large cross-ventilating windows
- Glazed, washable wall tiles to prevent filth build-up

FOCUS CLUE

How did the pavilion plan prevent cross-infection between wards?

5 1860–1890s

Professional Nurse Training & Asepsis

- 1860: Nightingale Training School at St Thomas'
- Nursing established as respected middle-class career
- Matrons enforced strict hygiene and moral discipline
- Late 19th c.: Germ Theory fused with nursing hygiene

FOCUS CLUE

How did nurse training permanently raise the standard of hospital care?

EXTENDED WRITING ASSESSMENT

Stimulus:

The pavilion hospital plan

(Response continues on facing page)

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KT3.3: Improvements in Hospital Care: Florence Nightingale & Professional Nursing QUESTION 4 CONTINUED

Continue your response to Question 4 below:

[illegible]

• QUESTION 3: EXPLAIN ONE DIFFERENCE [4 MARKS]

[4 MARKS • 5 MINS]

Explain one way in which hospital care in the late nineteenth century was different from hospital care in the Medieval period. [4 marks]

Hint: Contrast Florence Nightingale's sanitary pavilion hospitals staffed by trained nurses providing medical cure with medieval monastic hospitals offering spiritual care and rest ('care not cure').

Sentence Stems: One way hospital care differed was... • In the Medieval period, hospitals... • In contrast, in the late nineteenth century, Florence Nightingale...

KT3.3: Improvements in Hospital Care: Florence Nightingale & Professional Nursing

[illegible]

Why did the conquest of pain in surgery temporarily increase the patient death rate?

CHRONOLOGICAL INQUIRY SPINE • CORE CAUSAL NARRATIVE

Take precise, structured notes alongside each milestone as your teacher narrates the history

1 c1700–1846

Pre-Anaesthetic Surgery: Speed & Shock

- Patients held down; trauma and shock caused heart failure
- Surgeons prized raw speed (Liston: 28-second amputation)
- 1799: Humphry Davy discovers laughing gas
- 1846: William Morton demonstrates ether in Boston

FOCUS CLUE

Why was surgical speed essential before the discovery of anaesthetics?

2 1847–1853

James Simpson & Chloroform

- Nov 1847: Simpson discovers chloroform at dinner
- Relieved agony of childbirth; safer than volatile ether
- 1848: Hannah Greener dies from fatal overdose
- 1853: Queen Victoria uses chloroform for Prince Leopold

FOCUS CLUE

Why did the death of Hannah Greener cause panic among surgeons?

3 1846–1865

The "Black Period" of Surgery

- Anaesthetics allowed surgeons to operate deeper & longer
- Surgeons wore pus-stained frock coats as badges of pride
- Unwashed hands and catgut ligatures introduced germs
- Hospital gangrene and sepsis mortality surged dramatically

FOCUS CLUE

Why did conquering surgical pain lead to higher patient death rates?

4 1865–1870s

Joseph Lister & Carbolic Acid Spray

- Lister reads Pasteur; links cattle sewage treatment to wounds
- 1865: Uses carbolic acid on Jamie Greenlees' compound fracture
- Glasgow Infirmary amputee mortality drops from 46% to 15%
- 1867: Publishes antiseptic technique in *The Lancet*

FOCUS CLUE

How did Lister apply Germ Theory to solve hospital gangrene?

5 1880s–1890s

From Antiseptic to Aseptic Surgery

- Antiseptic: kills germs present (carbolic cracked hands)
- Aseptic: excludes all microbes from operating theatre
- 1881: Robert Koch invents high-pressure steam sterilizer
- 1890s: Rubber gloves (Halsted), surgical masks, sterile gowns

FOCUS CLUE

What is the crucial difference between antiseptic and aseptic surgery?

EXTENDED WRITING ASSESSMENT

(You must also use information of your own)

(Response continues on facing page)

[illegible]

☐ Done

[illegible]

[4 MARKS • 5 MINS]

Hint: Focus on the absolute necessity of raw surgical speed (e.g. Liston's 28-second amputations) and physical restraint, as effective chemical anaesthetics had not yet been discovered.

KT3.4: The Surgical Revolution: Simpson's Chloroform & Lister's Antiseptics

[illegible]

Why did it take 20 years for John Snow's cholera discovery to change government policy?

CHRONOLOGICAL INQUIRY SPINE • CORE CAUSAL NARRATIVE

Take precise, structured notes alongside each milestone as your teacher narrates the history

1 1831-1848

Epidemic Terror & Edwin Chadwick

- 1831: First cholera epidemic kills 50,000 Britons
- Violent vomiting, diarrhoea, blue skin; death within hours
- 1842: Edwin Chadwick links filth to poverty and disease
- 1848: Public Health Act creates local health boards (optional)

FOCUS CLUE

Why did towns refuse to set up health boards under the 1848 Act?

2 1854

John Snow & The Broad Street Pump

- August 1854: Severe cholera strikes Soho (500 die in 10 days)
- Snow plots deaths on spot map; clusters around Broad St pump
- Brewery workers drank beer, had private well—0 deaths
- Convinces parish vestry to remove the pump handle

FOCUS CLUE

How did Snow use epidemiological mapping to prove water transmission?

3 1854-1858

Board of Health & Miasma Orthodoxy

- General Board of Health and *The Lancet* reject Snow
- Orthodoxy claimed cholera arose from foul cesspool miasma
- Snow lacked bacteriological proof (Koch found cholera in 1883)
- Cesspool leaking into pump well discovered too late

FOCUS CLUE

Why did the medical establishment refuse to accept Snow's water theory?

4 1858-1865

The Great Stink & Bazalgette's Sewers

- Summer 1858: Unbearable Thames stench closes Parliament
- MPs fear miasma; fund Joseph Bazalgette's sewer network
- 1,300 miles of underground sewers divert waste to Thames estuary
- 1866: East London is only area to get cholera (unconnected)

FOCUS CLUE

Why did fear of miasma paradoxically save thousands from cholera?

5 1875

The 1875 Public Health Act: End of Laissez-Faire

- 1867 Reform Act gives working-class men the vote
- Disraeli's government passes landmark 1875 Public Health Act
- Compulsory: clean piped water, sewers, street cleaning, food checks
- Each council required to appoint a Medical Officer of Health

FOCUS CLUE

Why was the 1875 Act the definitive death blow to laissez-faire?

‘The work of John Snow was the main reason for improvements in public health in the nineteenth century.’ How far do you agree? [16+4 marks]

Stimulus: Edwin Chadwick’s 1842 Report The Public Health Act (1875) (You must also use information of your own)

Write your response in the space provided below: (Response continues on facing page)

Handwriting practice lines for the essay response.

TIMELINE MISSION

Turn to Pages 2–3 (Key Topic 3.5). In the drawing box, sketch John Snow’s Broad Street pump map and Bazalgette’s sewer network. Annotate how cholera forced Parliament to abandon laissez-faire!

[] Done

Continue your response to Question 5/6 below:

[illegible]

• QUESTION 3: EXPLAIN ONE DIFFERENCE [4 MARKS]

[4 MARKS • 5 MINS]

Explain one way in which government action on public health in the late nineteenth century was different from government action in the Renaissance. [4 marks]

Hint: Contrast the compulsory 1875 Public Health Act forcing local councils to provide clean water and sewers with Renaissance monarchs who only took temporary, reactive emergency measures during plague outbreaks.

Sentence Stems: One way government action differed was... • In the Renaissance period... • In contrast, under the 1875 Public Health Act, the government...

KT3.5: Public Health & Cholera: John Snow & The 1875 Public Health Act

[illegible]

PUPIL NAME: _____ TARGET: _____ CURRENT GRADE: _____

PERIOD CODE	ASSESSMENT COMPONENT FOCUS	TARIFF	SCORE	TEACHER INITIAL
KT3.1	Q4: Explain Why Rapid Progress in Causes c1860–c1890	[12]	/ 12	
KT3.2	Q5/6: Essay on Jenner Smallpox Vaccine • c1700–c1900	[16+4]	/ 20	
KT3.3	Q4: Explain Why Hospital Care & Nursing Improved	[12]	/ 12	
KT3.4	Q4: Explain Why Surgery Became Safer c1840–c1900	[12]	/ 12	
KT3.5	Q5/6: Essay on John Snow & 19th Century Public Health	[16+4]	/ 20	
KT3.1–3.5	Q3: Cross-Era Similarity / Difference Mastery (5 Questions)	[20]	/ 20	

• WHAT WENT WELL (WWW) • CORE HISTORICAL STRENGTHS:

• EVEN BETTER IF (EBI) • SPECIFIC EXAMINATION TARGET:

• DIGITAL LEARNING & RETRIEVAL HUB • INTERACTIVE LESSONS & QUIZZES

Interactive Textbook • 10 Questions Per Enquiry

KT3.1 Pasteur & Koch  LESSON HUB  MASTERY QUIZ Score: [/ 10]	KT3.2 Edward Jenner  LESSON HUB  MASTERY QUIZ Score: [/ 10]	KT3.3 F. Nightingale  LESSON HUB  MASTERY QUIZ Score: [/ 10]	KT3.4 Simpson & Lister  LESSON HUB  MASTERY QUIZ Score: [/ 10]	KT3.5 Snow & 1875 Act  LESSON HUB  MASTERY QUIZ Score: [/ 10]
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